Risk Management

Identification, Analysis and Planning

The table of risks contains the columns:

ID - The identifier for each risk, for easier identification and referencing in other project documents.

Risk - A description of the risk.

Likelihood (L) - A rating of Low (L), Moderate (M) or High (H), representing how common the risk is.

Difficulty To Amend/Fix (D) - A rating of Low (L), Moderate (M) or High (H), representing how much time or effort (or both) it would take to avert, amend or fix any issues caused by the given risk.

Severity (S) - A rating of Low (L), Moderate (M) or High (H), representing how much the risk (if occurred) would affect the progress of the project.

*(**L**, **D**, and **S** are colour coded appropriately with red (H), yellow (M) and green (L) for clarity and a more intuitive way of understanding the relevance of each risk. Naturally a risk of L,L,L is of less importance when considering a design than one of H,H,H; and the colour coding will be able to show at a glance how threatening a risk could be to a project.*
*There is also a footnote system to reference specific risks' **L**,**D**, or **S**, as sometimes only using a rating system is not sufficient to represent the scope of a problem.)*

Mitigation - A description of a solution that can avoid, amend or fix the risk if it arises.The solution should be very clear, however it does not have to be necessarily specific to any context (as otherwise then many risks could be incredibly similar). It is preferable that the mitigation strategy is applicable in multiple ways.

Category - Categorization of the type of risks:

- **Project** - The risk affects the schedule, equipment, staff or other resources required for the project to run smoothly.
- **Product** - The risk directly limits the quality and/or completeness of the product, or in some way changes how the product will be able to be developed in the future.
- **Business** - The risk affects the upper organisation that is developing the product (rarely applicable in this case.)

(Many risks are only one category, however there can also be an overlap in the types of risk that a risk falls into, and both/all categories should be specified.)

Owner - The person responsible for managing, assessing and often mitigating the risk.

We consider this table effective for the identification, analysis and planning against various risks and they will allow for risks to be clarified and made obvious, as well as giving a plan for mitigation and a system to eliminate them.

Risk Monitoring & Other

These risks will need to be monitored throughout the development of the project, and hence should be frequently updated, changed and added during the course of development. The relevant owner of the risk has a responsibility to use the mitigation strategy outlined to fix any issues, and report any more that arise from the solving of an issue. (as there may be a concern that the solving of one problem causes a different problem).

Table of Risks

ID	Risk	L	D	S	Mitigation	Category	Owner
R1	A team member is gone and unable to work (illness, accident, etc.)	M	M	M	Ensure there isn't any part where only one person has the knowledge to work on it. Keep the bus factor in mind.	Project	
R2	The implementation has a bug which completely breaks the game/makes it unable to run	M	L[1]	H	Test the game regularly. Use a version control system to revert to the last version where the game worked to find out where it went wrong.	Product	
R3	The implementation differs from the requirements in a significant way	L	H	H	Ensure the programmers are well informed of the requirements and are communicating well with the planners	Product	
R4	Programmers end up writing code which overwrites or conflicts with another's	M	M	M	Take a modular approach. Have programmers work on different aspects	Project	

1. Provided sufficient planning.